

Halden — customer support automation for mid-market SaaS

The Problem

A SaaS company with 40,000 customers receives around 9,000 support tickets a month. Roughly 60% are variations on eleven questions. Support teams answer them again and again, and the cost scales linearly with the customer base — which is the opposite of how software is supposed to work.

Existing automation makes this worse as often as better. Deflection bots answer confidently from a knowledge base that is out of date, and the customer ends up angrier than before, having spent four minutes to reach a human.

Our Solution

Halden answers support tickets from the product's actual state rather than from documentation.

When a customer asks why their invoice shows a charge they did not expect, we read their subscription, their usage and their billing history, and explain that specific charge. When we cannot answer with confidence, we route to a human with a summary of what we checked and why we stopped.

That last part matters more than the answers. A system that knows when to stop is the difference between deflection and automation.

The Market

Customer support software is a \$28B market. Our segment is B2B SaaS companies between \$5M and \$100M in revenue — about 24,000 companies — which have enough ticket volume to feel the cost and not enough headcount to absorb it.

Competition

This is a crowded category and getting more so. The incumbent helpdesk vendors all shipped AI features last year. A dozen funded startups do some version of what we do.

We are not going to win on being the only ones. We win deals on integration depth — we connect to the product's own data, not only to its help centre — and on our refusal rate, which we publish. Most competitors optimise for deflection percentage, which is the wrong metric and produces exactly the frustrating experience the category is known for.

The Team

Marcus Wei and Elena Popescu both come from support engineering rather than from machine learning. Marcus ran technical support at a developer tools company through a period when ticket volume grew eight-fold. Elena built internal tooling for a support organisation of 200 people.

Neither has built a company before, and neither has a research background. We have leaned on that: our product decisions come from having been on the receiving end of bad support automation.

Twenty-one people.

Traction

- 78 customers, average 2,400 tickets a month each
- \$4.1M annual recurring revenue, growing 6% month over month
- 52% of tickets resolved without human involvement, against a 71% industry claim we deliberately do not chase
- customer satisfaction on automated resolutions: 4.4/5, against 4.5 for human-handled
- net revenue retention 118%

The satisfaction parity is the number we care about. Deflection without it is just an obstacle course.

Business Model

Per-resolution pricing at \$0.90, with a monthly platform minimum. Average contract value is \$52,000. Gross margin is 74% after inference costs, which fall as we route more traffic to smaller models.

Per-resolution billing means we only earn when we actually solve something, which customers like and which makes our revenue track their volume rather than their headcount.

Go-To-Market

Direct sales to heads of support and customer experience, 6-week average cycle. Two helpdesk vendors have integration partnerships with us, which brings warm pipeline but also puts us one product decision away from being competed with directly.

Funding

We are raising \$11M to deepen integrations with the four most common billing systems, expand the

refusal-detection work, and build out a sales team that is currently three people.